VXIII

BRAND STORY

MATTHEW 5:13 · KEEP YOUR SAVOUR

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01 THE NAME

VXIII is one word and one reference, Matthew 5:13. The V stands for the chapter and the XIII for the verse, so a single word carries the whole citation. It is always written as one word, with no space and no mark between the letters.

The verse opens with "Ye are the salt of the earth" (KJV) and goes on to ask what happens when salt has lost its savour. We take that question as the premise of the brand: a person is worth what they keep of themselves.

The next verse, 5:14, reads "Ye are the light of the world." VXIII sits one verse before the light. The wearer is the salt, and the frame is what they wear into the light.

02 THE IDEA IN ONE LINE

Keep your savour.

03 WHY SALT, AND WHY SUNGLASSES

Salt is made by the sun. Sea water is let into shallow pans and left under hard light until only crystal remains. The light that makes salt is the light a pair of sunglasses is built to face.

Salt preserves. Scripture calls a lasting promise "a covenant of salt" (Numbers 18:19 and 2 Chronicles 13:5). A frame bought once and kept for years follows the same logic, and our promise to the buyer is written as a covenant.

Salt is noticed by its absence. Nobody sees salt in a meal, and people notice it only when it is missing. VXIII is worn the same way. The mark sits where only the wearer sees it, and a frame is judged by how well it suits a face.

Salt has a measure. The Latin word salarium, from which salary comes, is built on sal, the Latin for salt. The phrase "worth your salt" still means someone has earned their place. We speak to people who intend to be worth it.

04 WHO WE SPEAK TO

We speak to people who buy few things and keep them. They value a good material and a clean line, and they choose an object for how it is made before they look at the name on it.

They come to us through a friend or through the verse itself. Most already own sunglasses they have lost or outgrown, and they want one pair that stays. We write to them as equals, with the plain confidence of someone who has nothing to prove.

05 WHAT THE FRAMES TAKE FROM SALT

Every shape and detail in the range must trace back to a real form of salt. The list below is the full vocabulary. A construction that cannot name its source on this list does not go forward.

SOURCE	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT CAN GIVE A FRAME
The halite cube	Rock salt crystallises as a cube and breaks cleanly along right angles.	Square proportions, true edges, cube end pieces and hinge blocks.
The hopper crystal	Fleur de sel forms on the surface of the pan as fine flakes, many of them stepped and hollow.	A stepped detail at the corner, the hinge or the temple tip.
The evaporation line	As brine dries, it leaves white rings of salt along the edge of the water, one inside another.	A double line around the lens, and a lens edge polished to catch the light.
The pan	Salt pans are shallow rectangles divided by low walls of clay.	Rectangular lens shapes and flat, level top lines.
The terrace	At Maras in Peru, several thousand salt pools step down a mountainside.	A stepped profile in the bridge or the temple.
The crust	On the Salar de Uyuni in Bolivia, the dry salt cracks into a field of hexagons.	Hexagonal and faceted lens shapes, and the cracked pattern used on packaging.
The clear crystal	A clean salt crystal is translucent, and light passes through it.	Clear acetate, through which the titanium inside can be seen.

06 THE STORY

There is a verse most people know by its first line and forget by its second. You are the salt of the earth. The second line is the one that matters. If the salt has lost its savour, what is left to season anything with?

We built VXIII on the second line.

Salt is added to something so that the thing becomes more itself. A good cook uses very little and the whole dish changes. We hold a frame to the same standard. It sits close to the face, and every line in it comes from the way salt is formed.

Salt is born in the sun, and that is the right place to begin a pair of sunglasses. The light is strongest in the hours when the pans are drying, and those are the hours this brand is made for.

We number the verse instead of a product line, because the reference is the promise. Anyone who knows the verse will recognise it. Anyone who does not will ask, and the answer is a good one to be asked for.

You are the salt of the earth. Keep your savour. Put the frame on and go out into the light.

07 · MANIFESTO

YOU ARE THE SALT OF THE EARTH.

A LITTLE SALT CHANGES EVERYTHING IT IS ADDED TO.

THE SUN THAT DRIES THE PANS IS THE LIGHT YOU WALK INTO. MEET IT WITH SOMETHING THAT HOLDS ITS EDGE.

KEEP YOUR SAVOUR.

VXIII

MATTHEW 5:13

08 BRAND PILLARS

PILLAR	MEANING	WHERE IT SHOWS
Savour	Keeping what is yours	The tagline and the tone of every line of copy
Crystal	Every form taken from the way salt is made	The construction of each frame and the geometry of the packaging
Covenant	A promise made in writing	Warranty, returns and care text
Quiet	Marks placed where only the wearer sees them	The engraving inside the temple

09 VOICE

- Plain declarative sentences, with one idea in each.
- Scripture appears at the name, in the manifesto and in the engraving. Everywhere else the voice is modern and direct.
- Salt words are used as ordinary vocabulary and are never forced into a pun.
- No exclamation marks and no discount language.
- No emoji.
- Short captions in capitals, as on the spec lines of a product page.

Vocabulary

WE SAY	WE AVOID
Savour	Style, vibe
Crystal, cut, edge	Sleek, modern
Keep	Own, buy
Season	Collection, drop
Covenant	Terms and conditions
Grain	Detail
Pan	Workshop, studio

Lines we use

- Keep your savour.
- Worth your salt.
- Made where the sun makes salt.
- You are the salt of the earth. Put it on.
- One verse before the light.

10 THE RANGE

VXIII is two models, one for men and one for women, each in four colourways. That makes eight frames.

MODEL	WEARER	NAME SOURCE
Halite	Men	Rock salt, the cube cut from the earth. Hard and square.
Fleur	Women	Fleur de sel, the first and finest crystals skimmed from the surface of the pan.

The shape and construction of each model are set in the product construction document, where three concepts for each model are drawn for approval.

11 MATERIAL

Titanium carries the structure of every frame, including the hinges, the bridge, the temples and the screws. Acetate is used where a design calls for it, either cut clear like a salt crystal or in a mineral colour. Every lens is polarised with UV400 protection.

12 COLOUR

Every colourway takes its colour from salt or from the making of it, and every name comes from the same source. The colourways are chosen in the colourways document against research into what men and women buy, so that each one is a colour people already wear, named for a salt.

13 THE MARK

The engraving sits on the inner faces of the temples, where only the wearer sees it. The left temple carries "VXIII" with the first line of the verse beside it and the size of the frame, small and set apart, and the right temple carries "Keep your savour". The front of the frame and the lens carry no mark.

14 MESSAGING

LEVEL	MESSAGE
Idea	Keep your savour.
Proposition	Sunglasses in titanium and acetate, in two models named for salt, with every line taken from the way salt is formed.
Proof	A titanium structure in every frame. Polarised lenses with UV400 protection. The mark engraved inside the temple. A promise written as a covenant.
Origin	A reference to Matthew 5:13, written as one word.

Boilerplate, fifty words

VXIII takes its name from Matthew 5:13, "Ye are the salt of the earth." The brand makes sunglasses in two models, Halite for men and Fleur for women, each drawn from the way salt is formed and built on titanium. Every frame is engraved inside the temple. Keep your savour.

Short description, twenty words

Sunglasses in two models, Halite and Fleur, built on titanium, drawn from salt and engraved with the verse.